GOPAL GOVINDHARAJAN
SENIOR SALES ENGINEER - INDIA OEM, DELL EMC

Internet of Things:

"There will be more than 300 PER CENT INCREASE in INVESTMENT in AI in 2017"

Gopal Govindharajan, senior sales engineer - India OEM, Dell EMC, speaks with Shanosh Kumar from EFY about the latest disruptions in Blockchain, natural language processing, artificial intelligence and other interesting technology trends in the Internet of Things (IoT) space, which is no longer in its infancy

Q. How has computing evolved with the influence of the IoT?

A. Before the client server architecture evolved, centralised Unix architecture was the best and most promising technology. With advancements in technology, there has been a paradigm shift in the way computing is done, and this has paved the way for two- and three-tier architectures. There is also a possibility that this might undergo another massive transformation within a decade.

Q. What led to the development of the IoT?

A. Prominent factors facilitating this change could be the chaotic and unprecedented growth of devices, data, lack of a uniform platform for seamless interoperability and so on. With connected enterprise becoming a reality, IoT devices, normally understood to share information and connect to a network like that of sensors, have also started real-time computing on-the-fly.

Edge analytics has become a standard package of any intelligent gateway. Some gateways also work on the store and forward model, depending on the use case. This means that the gateway needs to have some storage space as well.

Q. Currently, what are the most disruptive technologies in this space?

A. Blockchain is still at a nascent stage in terms of adoption for businesses. Despite numerous positive effects of this technology, there are a few downsides that make many enterprises cautious of its adoption. However, Blockchain is still touted to be the most disruptive technology in the near future. The banking industry is among the early adopters of Blockchain technology due to the security and ease of operations it offers.

There has also been increased traction due to the potential to transform key parts of our economy through new fraud-proof, crowd-sourced and open trusted mechanisms. Financial institutions will break away from other industries as they welcome Blockchain into their systems.

Q. What is the hottest technology you see for 2017?

A. The year 2017 will see an increase in artificial intelligence (AI) being used to mine the data coming from IoT devices. AI has already been making a mark through aiding real-time decision-making. In AI's future, developing more natural language capabilities will help to further realise the potential of a connected IoT world, as natural language based data descriptions will provide a universal way to understand data among various types of devices.

According to Forrester, there will be more than 300 per cent increase in investment in AI in 2017 as compared with 2016. As the IoT gets distributed across the edge and Cloud, insights will be boosted by the use of AI and containers. This approach could be expanded to allow humans to communicate with the IoT directly through voice or text.

Q. Do you foresee AI having an immediate effect on the way things are currently done in engineering?

A. According to Future Workforce Study, 34 per cent of Indian workers have said that their biggest concern about AI is that they would become too reliant on it to perform day-to-day tasks. Some companies are using the opportunity to retrain employees and teach them new skill sets. For example, soon data scientists will start training machines to go beyond reviewing large data pools for insights and answers, and helping machines develop the knowledge to read between the layers. Through the ability to communicate via spoken languages, AI will be able to interpret data differently, as it will be able to break it down more succinctly, identify and share nuances that would otherwise not be seen within a large swathe of information.

Q. Which IoT technology has the power to strongly touch the lives of consumers?

A. In about five to ten years, you can expect to witness the emergence of commercially-available embedded clothes, pendants and other wearables that measure body vitals non-invasively and transmit the details to remote doctors at regular intervals for diagnosis. EFY